

Group Project: Design and Run an AI Policy Simulation

Interactive Simulation: Governing the AI Future

What this is. Your team will design and run a **15-minute public-hearing simulation** (plus a 5-minute debrief) based on a real AI policy dilemma. The goal is to help the class *experience* the political, ethical, and strategic complexity of a high-stakes decision facing governments, regulators, or international bodies today. This is not a research presentation or a business plan. It is a live, structured exercise in political decision-making: you define the problem, assign roles, run the hearing, and propose a concrete policy solution under time pressure. You saw the format in the Day 4 town hall on a data center.

What You'll Do

Each team (3–4 students) will:

- Choose a pressing AI policy question (for example, should a frontier model be delayed for a government safety audit?).
- Design a 15-minute public-hearing simulation with live stakeholder engagement.
- Write 4–6 stakeholder role cards (one paragraph each).
- Facilitate the hearing in class: assign roles, moderate, and manage timing.
- Deliver a short wrap-up policy recommendation.

The Format: A Public Hearing

Your simulation revolves around one specific, debatable policy decision, run as a formal hearing, such as a congressional or regulatory committee session.

- Assign 4–6 classmates to **stakeholder roles** and 2–3 classmates to a **hearing panel**.
- Each stakeholder opens with a brief statement (about one minute) giving their position on the proposed policy.
- The panel then questions the stakeholders and may deliberate briefly.
- The class reflects or votes, and your team delivers a wrap-up recommendation.

Do not script the discussion. You may give brief background on each stakeholder's position, but the students who play the roles must develop and express their arguments in their own words. The point is for everyone to think critically, respond to competing views, and engage with real-world complexity.

This format works best for politically charged or high-profile issues that raise questions of public legitimacy, such as rules on deepfakes, misinformation regulation, or public AI procurement.

How to Prepare and Reach Your Recommendation

Your final recommendation should reflect the real political and institutional considerations raised during the hearing, not just personal opinion. That takes preparation. Your team should:

- **Frame the problem:** What exactly is being decided? Why is it urgent now? Who has authority over it? Who stands to win or lose?
- **Engage the readings and current debates:** Use course readings and credible sources to identify competing values, legal constraints, and historical context. Do not treat the issue as if you are starting from scratch.
- **Develop stakeholder perspectives:** Write role cards based on real institutions, companies, or communities. What are their incentives and concerns? What position would each likely take, and why?

- **Design for conflict:** Set up the hearing so that stakeholders will disagree. A good simulation creates friction that reveals political trade-offs.
- **Draw conclusions in real time:** Plan in advance how you will process the discussion, but do not pre-write the conclusion. One or two team members lead a short debrief right after the hearing, responding directly to the arguments and conflicts that actually came up.

Deliverables

Upload to ADAM: Deliverables / Final Simulation Materials. Include your group number with each assignment.

- **Day 4 (Thursday) — Project Proposal (1 paragraph).** What is the policy issue? What is the decision? Why is it urgent?
- **Day 6 (Tuesday) — Draft Simulation Plan.** Final decision question and stakeholder list (titles only).
- **Day 8 (Thursday) — Simulation Packet and Presentation.** Explanatory paragraph, role cards (4–6), simulation plan (flow and timing), slides (maximum 3), and decision method for a 15-minute hearing plus a 5-minute wrap-up and recommendation.
- **Day 8 (Thursday) — In-Class Simulation.** Each team runs its simulation during the final session. Be ready to set up quickly, assign roles, and manage the clock. You have 20 minutes total: 15 for the hearing and 5 for the debrief and final recommendation.

Stakeholder Role Cards

Each role card is one paragraph and includes:

- Name, title, and affiliation
- Position on the issue
- Motivation or red line

Design Tips

- Give each role a clear goal, a distinct position, and a red line.
- Keep the structure simple and tight: who speaks when, and how the decision is made.
- Engage the audience: use volunteers for roles, voting tools, or open questions.
- Role cards are starting points, not scripts. Players must speak in their own words and react to the discussion as it unfolds.
- Slides support the simulation, they do not replace it. Maximum of three.

Grading Rubric

- **Simulation Design (30%)** — Realistic, engaging scenario with clear policy conflict.
- **Execution (30%)** — Smooth timing, effective facilitation, stakeholder engagement.
- **Policy Insight (20%)** — Wrap-up recommendation is politically informed and justified.
- **Preparation (20%)** — Materials are complete, polished, and submitted on time.

Final Advice

- Focus on trade-offs, not ideal outcomes.
- Make the decision hard. That is where the learning happens.
- Use real-world logic: institutions have constraints, and stakeholders have power.

This assignment is designed to challenge you to think like a policymaker, making decisions under time pressure, with imperfect information and competing interests at stake.

Questions? Reach out early. I am happy to review your ideas and offer feedback.